WaggleKin: Conversion (CRO) Audit, Strategy & Changes

Date: 13 November 2026.

How the audit was done:

- A full walkthrough of wagglekin.com on desktop and iPhone: home, menu, collections, search, product pages, cart and Shopify checkout. No order was placed.
- A line-by-line review of the theme code.
- Research into how Chewy, Amazon, Petco, PetSmart, BARK, Wild One, Fable, Allbirds, Glossier and Warby Parker convert, checked against Baymard Institute and Nielsen Norman Group UX research.
- A check of what Shopify Basic allows.

1. What was hurting conversion

Problem found	Impact	Status
Choosing a colour or size never changed the photo. Links to a specific variant, as used by Google Shopping and ads, also opened on the wrong photo.	Shoppers can't see what they're buying, which leads to wrong orders and returns	**Fixed**
The whole site showed "sold out", and add-to-cart failed: the US market had no shipping enabled	No one could buy anything	**Fixed 12 Nov**
"Add to cart" on product cards silently added the first size or colour	Wrong-size orders on 121 products	**Fixed**: cards now show "Choose options"
No related or suggested products anywhere; add-to-cart only showed a 3.5-second toast	Every visit was a dead end, with no basket building	**Fixed**: related products, cart drawer, cart upsells
The homepage promised "15% off 3+ items" and "10% off for joining", but **no discounts exist**	Broken promises damage trust and invite complaints	**Copy made truthful** (decision needed, see §5)
The **Shipping, Returns and Terms policy pages returned 404**, and the Contact page was blank	Destroys trust, and Google Merchant Center and Meta Shops require these policies	Contact page **fixed**; **policies need you** (see §5)
Gambling spam ("casino", "starbet") sat inside 2 TopDawg dog-food descriptions	Google spam and Merchant Center risk	**Both products hidden**; TopDawg must fix the text
A cart under $49 mixing CJ and TopDawg items is charged $11.98 in shipping, not $5.99	A surprise cost at checkout, the #1 reason for cart abandonment (Baymard)	Explained in the cart; upsells no longer create mixed carts (see §5)
"Bestseller" badges and "our best sellers" copy, but the store has no sales yet	False social proof	**Removed**
The Dogs collection opened with a wall of dog-food bags and $191–$355 wholesale display boxes	A poor first impression on the most-visited page	**Re-ordered** (curated order on 6 collections)
No filters, no product count, no search suggestions; a dead-end "no results" page	Hard to find things	**Fixed**
On mobile, the first screen was all image and thumbnails, with no sticky buy button and no zoom	Lower mobile add-to-cart rate	**Fixed**

Problem found	Impact	Status
No structured data; og:image used http	Weaker Google listings and social previews	**Fixed**

2. What the big stores do, and what we adopted

Pattern (who does it)	Evidence	WaggleKin now
Variant photo follows the colour you pick (Amazon, Chewy, Allbirds)	Baymard: shoppers rely on product images to judge a product, so showing the chosen variant is a basic expectation	Photo swaps instantly (no blank flash), the option label shows your choice, impossible or sold-out combinations are crossed out, and the page jumps to the nearest real variant
Arrival **date**, not "x days" (Amazon, Chewy)	Baymard: delivery dates beat speed ranges	"Order today, estimated delivery Thu, Nov 19 – Wed, Nov 25" (business days, skips weekends)
Free-shipping threshold and progress (Chewy and PetSmart at $49, Allbirds, Glossier)	Unexpected costs are the #1 abandonment reason (Baymard ~48%)	Product page states "$5.99 otherwise" or "Add $X more"; the cart shows a progress bar
Slide-out cart with add-ons (Allbirds, Gymshark, Chewy's "added to cart" panel)	Keeps shoppers on the page and lifts order value	Cart drawer: qty +/−, remove, 3 relevant add-ons that fit the gap to $49, Checkout
"You may also like" + "Pairs well with" (Amazon, Chewy)	Recommendations are a known driver of order value	Same category, same pet, same shipping speed; "Pairs well with" switches on once you set pairings (see §5)
Sticky add-to-cart on mobile (Gymshark, Glossier)	More reachable buy button on long pages	Appears after the main button scrolls away, showing the chosen variant and price
Image zoom and swipe gallery (all of them)	Shoppers judge product quality from photos	Swipe on mobile with a counter; tap or click to zoom with arrows
Search as you type (Amazon, Chewy, Petco)	Search users convert better; dead ends lose them	Products with photo and price after 2 letters, plus categories; "Popular with the pack" on no results
Filters with counts (all pet retailers)	Big grids need narrowing	Availability and price now; pet, size and colour once set up in Search & Discovery
Plain guarantee + trust near the buy button (BARK, Wild One)	A new brand must earn trust	30-day returns, secure checkout and payment icons beside the button; Shipping and Returns accordions
Honest social proof only (everyone)	Fake reviews or badges backfire and are illegal under the FTC 2024 rule	No fake reviews or badges; reviews to come from real buyers (see §5)

3. Theme changes (all tested on a preview theme, desktop + iPhone)

Product page:

- breadcrumbs;
- variant photo switching with preloading;

- crossed-out unavailable options and auto-selection of the nearest real variant;
- single-value options hidden ("Color: Dry");
- quantity stepper;
- "Buy with Shop Pay" hidden when the choice is unavailable;
- delivery date estimate and a shipping-cost line;
- payment icons;
- Description, Shipping & delivery, and Returns & guarantee accordions;
- "Pairs well with" slot;
- sticky add-to-cart on mobile;
- zoom lightbox;
- Product and BreadcrumbList structured data;
- app-block slot for future review apps.

"You may also like" section:

- **Picks:** same category, same pet, same shipping speed; no food on non-food pages; no wholesale boxes.
- **Setting:** switches to Shopify's automatic picks once the store has sales history.

Cart drawer:

- opens on every add-to-cart;
- free-shipping progress bar;
- a note when items ship from 2 warehouses;
- delivery badge per line;
- qty +/− and remove without page reloads;
- "Complete your order" add-ons: same pet, same warehouse, priced to close the gap to $49, never food;
- Checkout button.

Cart page: the same progress bar and upsells, delivery badges, and a trust line with payment icons.

Collections:

- breadcrumbs and product count;
- filters with active-filter chips and Clear all;
- sorting that keeps the filters;
- square images showing the whole product on white;
- first row of images loads immediately.

Search: search as you type in the header; product-only results page with a count; popular picks when nothing matches.

Contact page: a real form with name, email, order number, dog/cat and message.

Homepage copy: every claim is true today ("Free US shipping on orders over $49", US-only, no phantom discounts or quiz, no placeholders).

Fixes:

- broken mobile menu on small phones;
- desktop dropdown snapping shut;
- supplier hash codes used as image alt text;

- screen-reader price labels;
- og:image over https.

4. Store changes made through the Admin API

- **Curated order** on Dogs, Cats, Fast US Shipping, Walk, Toys and Beds:
  - First: everyday best sellers, then US-shipped products with several photos.
  - Pushed down: food bags. At the very bottom: wholesale display boxes.
  - New arrivals is sorted newest first.
- **Hidden:** 2 TopDawg dog foods with injected gambling spam (Grain Free Puppy, Free Spirit).
- **Removed:** the `badge:Bestseller` tag from 2 products.
- **Shipping profile tidy-up:**
  - The 5 original products moved into the CJ profile, so CJ-only carts pay one $5.99.
  - Mixed CJ + TopDawg carts still pay per warehouse under $49. That's a Shopify Basic limitation (see §5).

5. What needs you (in priority order)

1. **Write the store policies** (Settings → Policies): Refund, Shipping, Terms of service, Contact information. Footer links currently lead to a 404. Draft text is in §7; check it and paste it in, or tell Claude to publish it.
2. **Decide on offers**, then Claude can create them in Shopify and restore the copy:
   - **Welcome offer:** "Free shipping on your first order" costs less than 10% off on orders under $49, or 10% off if margins allow.
   - **Multi-buy:** 15% off 3+ items is risky on TopDawg items priced at MSRP (thin margins). A safer version is 10% off 3+ items, US-shipped CJ products only.
3. **Install Shopify Search & Discovery** (free, by Shopify):
   - add "complementary" pairings for your top 20–30 products (harness → leash, poop bags; litter box → mat, scoop; fountain → filters, mat). "Pairs well with" and the cart add-ons then use them automatically;
   - add filters for Pet, Size and Colour;
   - add search synonyms (kitty→cat, pup→dog, lead→leash).
4. **Reviews:** install Judge.me (free plan) for post-purchase review requests. Never import or seed reviews.
5. **Fix the TopDawg copy in TopDawg's Import List** (Shopify edits get overwritten):
   - remove the spam in the 2 hidden foods, then unhide them;
   - tidy titles such as "SCP …" and "LP …";
   - delete the diabetes and allergy claim on Dr. Becker's Bites.
6. **Mixed-warehouse shipping:**
   - **Option A (current):** keep as is. The cart explains it, and upsells don't create mixed carts.
   - **Option B:** make TopDawg shipping free on orders over about $20. This removes the double charge but costs margin on small TopDawg-only orders.
7. **Brand the checkout** (Settings → Checkout → Customize: logo, colours; allowed on Basic) and set the homepage SEO title and description (Online Store → Preferences).
8. **Holiday:**
   - Christmas items shipped from China need an order cut-off of about **30 Nov**;
   - consider a "Order by Dec 15 for Christmas delivery" line for US-warehouse items.

9. **WaggleKin TV:** the homepage shows "Episode 1 · Coming soon" with no video. Add the first episode, or hide the section until it exists.

6. How to measure (Shopify Analytics, Basic plan)

- **Before / after funnel:** sessions → add to cart → reached checkout → purchased, filtered to human traffic. Note the baseline on deploy day.
- **Reports to watch:** "Product recommendation conversions", "Searches with no results", "Sessions by landing page".
- **A/B testing:** with little traffic, A/B tests can't reach significance yet. Ship evidence-backed defaults first, then test (for example $49 vs $39 threshold, welcome offer A vs B) once there are about 1,000 sessions a week.

7. Draft policies (check before publishing)

Shipping policy (draft):

- We ship to US addresses only.
- Shipping is **free on orders of $49 or more**; otherwise it's $5.99 per shipment.
- Items marked "Fast US shipping" ship from our US warehouse and usually arrive in **3–7 business days**.
- Items marked "Value pick" ship from our international warehouse and usually arrive in **7–14 business days**.
- Some orders ship from more than one warehouse and arrive in separate parcels, each with its own tracking number. On orders under $49, shipping is charged per parcel.
- Orders are processed within 1–2 business days.
- You'll receive tracking by email as soon as your order ships.

Refund policy (draft):

- You have **30 days from delivery** to request a return or refund. Email us with your order number.
- Items must be unused and in original packaging, except faulty or damaged items, which we always replace or refund.
- *[Decide: who pays return shipping, and whether low-cost items are refunded without a return.]*
- Refunds go back to your original payment method within 5–10 business days of approval.
- For hygiene reasons, opened food, treats and grooming consumables can't be returned unless faulty.

Contact information (draft):

- WaggleKin
- Email: *[support email]*
- We reply within 1 business day, Monday–Friday.
- *[Business address of the US LLC]*